

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

2024 Stack Overflow Survey

Key findings on employment patterns, salary benchmarks,
and workforce preferences from the world's largest developer survey.

Source: survey.stackoverflow.co/2024



65,437

respondents

180+ countries

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.

69%

Full-time
Employed

16.4%

Freelance /
Contract

13.2%

Full-time
Students

U.S. Full-Time Employment Trend

69% 2023

→ 64.8% 2024

4.2 percentage-point drop year-over-year

U.K. & Ukraine: lean toward independent contracting.
Germany & India: lean toward full-time students.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%

42%

Hybrid

Consistent with 2023

38%

Remote

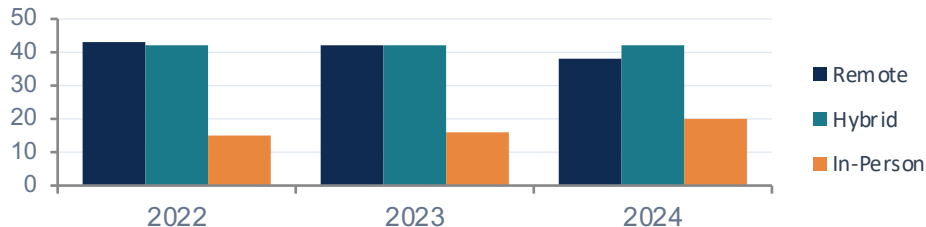
Fully distributed

20%

In-Person

Up from 15% in 2022

In-Person Work: Three-Year Trend



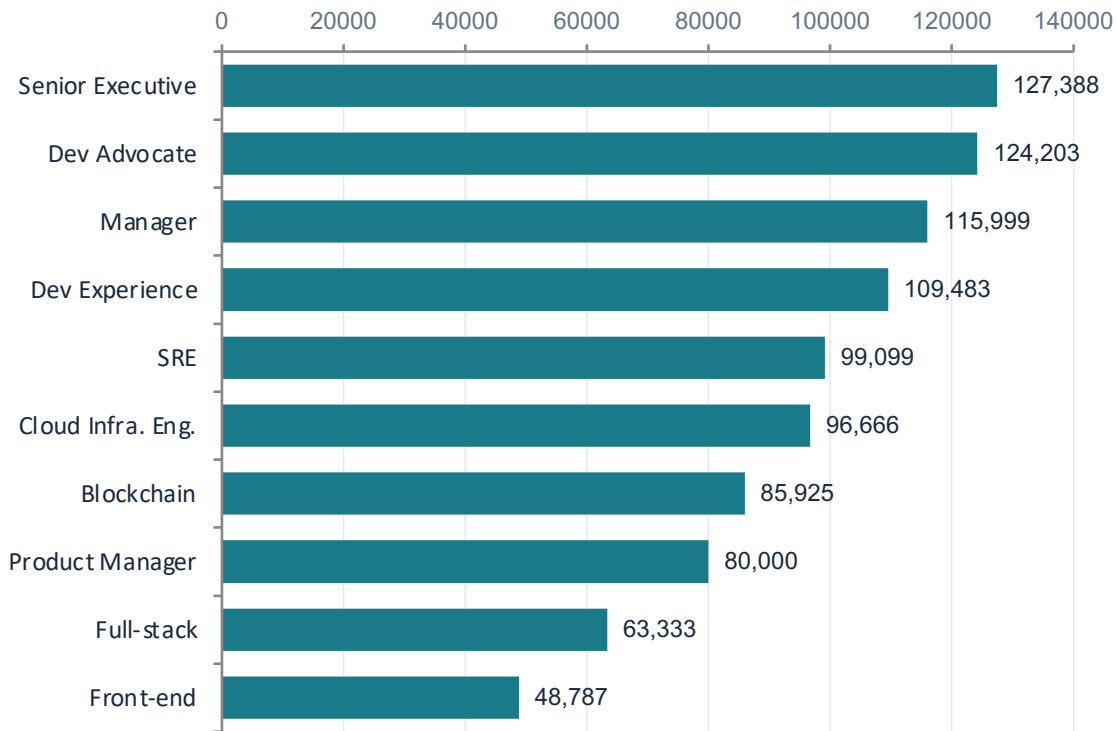
Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Survey | n = 65,437

Key Insight

In-person work has risen for the third consecutive year — from 15% in 2022 to 20% in 2024 — signaling a gradual return-to-office trend.

Hybrid remains dominant at 42%, consistent year over year.

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Survey | n = 22,677 salary responses (34.7% response rate)

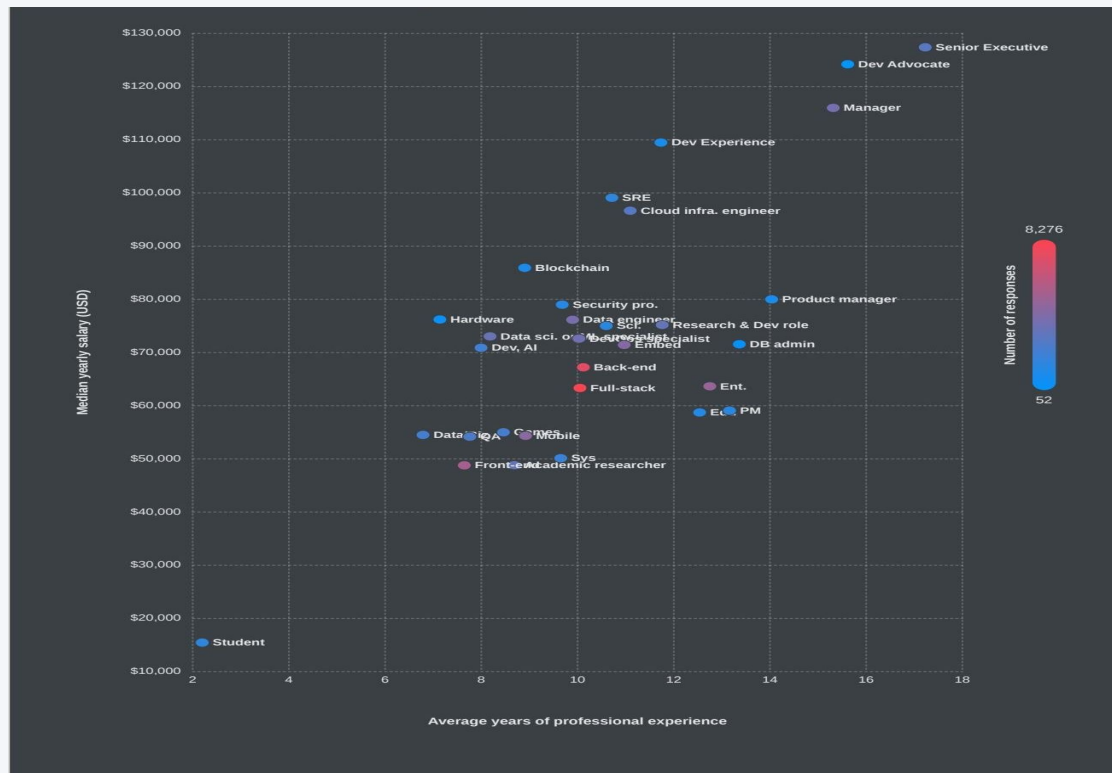
Highlights

SRE and Cloud Infra are the highest-paid purely technical roles, reflecting their critical role in keeping digital services running.

Regional Variations

U.S.: Mobile devs earn more
Germany/Ukraine: Data engineers top charts
India/U.K.: Back-end developers lead

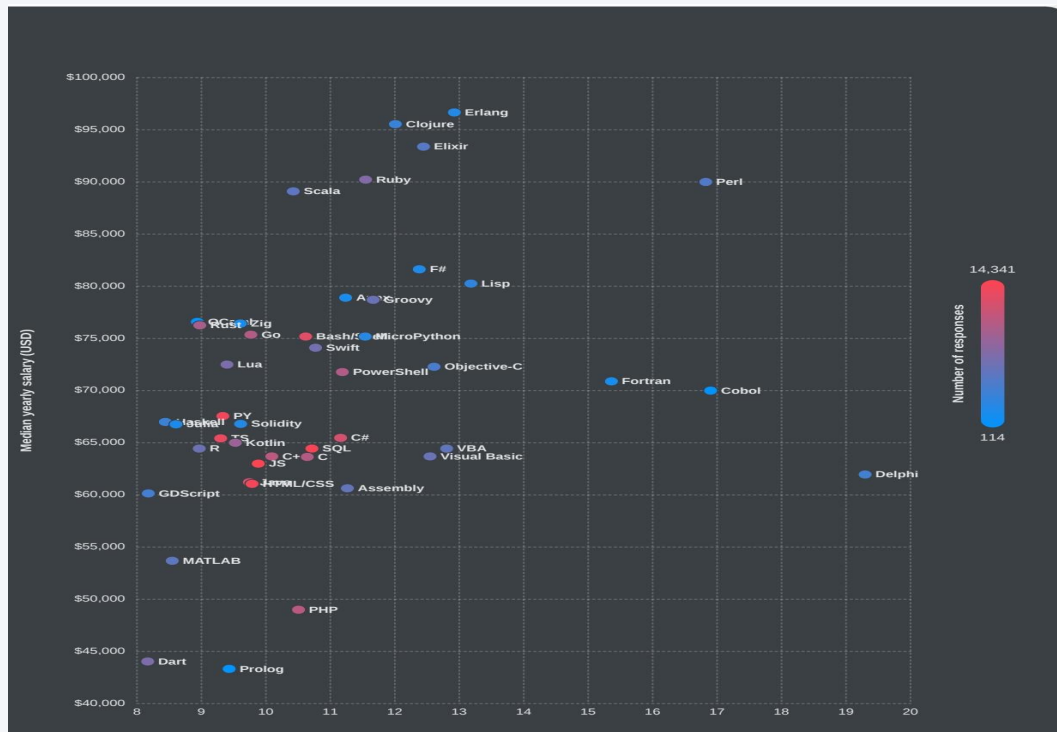
Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries



Outlier

Students earn \$15,466 median with only ~2 years experience — the extreme lower-left point on the scatter plot.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K



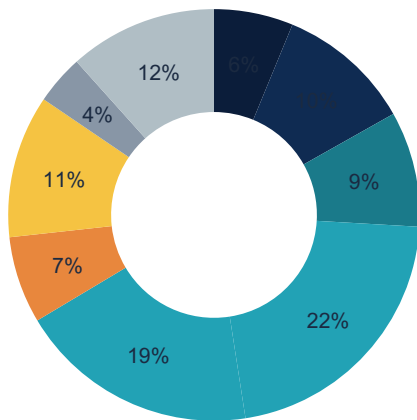
Year-over-Year

Reported salary range dropped
~\$10K vs. 2023, now averaging \$60–
75K vs. \$70–85K last year.

Niche functional languages (Erlang,
Clojure, Elixir) consistently command
premium pay >\$93K.

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases

Company Size Distribution



■ Solo ■ 2-9 ■ 10-19 ■ 20-99 ■ 100-499 ■ 500-999 ■ 1K-4.9K ■ 5K-9.9K ■ 10K+

47% of developers work at organizations with fewer than 100 employees

Source: Stack Overflow 2024 Survey | n = 42,827

Technology Purchasing Influence

62% of developers influence technology purchases at their organization

99% Sr. Executives

87% Eng. Managers

77% Product Mgrs

60% prefer build-and-buy | 75% start with a free trial | 73% ask other devs

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

01

Plan for More Contractors

U.S. full-time employment fell 4 pp year-over-year. Freelancing and contracting remain significant at 16%+. Build flexible workforce strategies.

02

Hybrid Still Dominates, but In-Person Is Growing

In-person mandates rose to 20% (from 15% in 2022), but hybrid at 42% remains the norm. Offer flexibility to attract top talent.

03

DevRel and SRE Roles Command Premium Pay

Dev Advocates (\$124K) and SREs (\$99K) are among the highest-paid roles. Budget accordingly for these competitive markets.

04

Language Choice Correlates with Pay

Niche functional languages (Erlang, Clojure, Elixir) pay >\$93K median. Mainstream languages like JavaScript and PHP sit well below \$65K.

05

Engage Developers Directly in Purchasing

62% of developers influence tech purchases. Vendor strategies should target individual contributors alongside management.